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NORTHFIELD HEALTH

State Standing Order Delegation Rule

Document ID:	NFH-REG-2024
Version:	v1.0
Authority Tier:	Tier 1 - Regulatory Statute
Document Type:	State regulation (excerpted)
Owner:	Office of Legal and Regulatory Affairs
Approver:	State Department of Health (rule adopted)
Department:	Legal and Regulatory Affairs
Effective Date:	July 1, 2024
Last Reviewed:	March 3, 2026
Next Review:	March 3, 2027
Status:	Current - Ratified

Section 14-1. Purpose

This rule sets the conditions under which hospital medical staff may approve standing orders that allow licensed nursing staff to start protocolized treatment before an individual prescriber order is written.

Section 14-2. Definitions

A standing order is a written, medical-staff-approved protocol that lists the clinical criteria, the treatment to be given, the staff roles authorized to give it, and the patient groups excluded from it.

Section 14-8. Delegated Administration

Hospital standing orders approved by the medical staff provide legally compliant coverage for registered nurses to initiate protocolized treatment, deferring prescriber counter-signature for up to 4 hours after initiation, provided that (a) the standing order is current and ratified, and (b) the standing order lists explicit exclusion criteria.

Section 14-9. Excluded Patient Groups

Patient groups excluded by the approving protocol, including pediatric patients under 18 years of age where the protocol so states, remain subject to an individual prescriber order before treatment starts.

Section 14-11. Review of Standing Orders

Each standing order must be reviewed by the approving committee at least once every 12 months. A standing order that is past its review date must be flagged to the medical staff office.